Chaz A. Straney

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Skills

- Committed to fostering quality engineering practices in the Platform Engineering space through collaboration, dialog and mentoring
- Proficient in languages including Golang, Python, Javascript and Ruby. Some professional experience in PHP, C and Objective-C
- Over seven years experience running Kubernetes in production and deep familiarity with Kubernetes-native patterns and applications
- Nine years experience supporting containerized workloads in production and Docker-based development environments
- Passionate about application and platform design for flexibility, extensibility and maintainability
- Has designed, implemented and supported production-level microservices-based architecture as both a product developer and a platform engineer at multiple organizations
- Deep experience using a host of other DevOps/Cloud technologies in production including Terraform, Packer, Ansible, Consul, Vault, Cloud Foundry, Datadog and others
- Over a decade of experience with Amazon Web Services and Google Cloud Platform

Experience

- **Garner Health** — Remote
  Senior Site Reliability Engineer — *January 2025-Present*
  - Inventoried legacy AWS account and wrangled stakeholders to create a plan for decommissioning
  - Enhanced a golang-based developer CLI to enable robust local access to services within EKS and a multi-project local containerized workflow for engineers
  - Coordinated and executed high-risk upgrades of business-critical internal tooling
  - Operationalized self-hosted Dagster as a data orchestration tool for multiple data teams
  - Helped refactor flaky Argo Workflows deployment which was causing failures in ETL system
  - Led the rollout of default branch protection across the organization, with acompanying improvements to CI to meet HITRUST certification requirements
- **Calendly** — Remote
  Senior Site Reliability Engineer — *September 2020-January 2025*
  - As technical lead, facilitated the growth and development of a new SWE team focused on Developer Experience and Enablement with a focus on accelerating the SDLC for microservice adoption
  - Advocated for, designed, implemented and supported a 'paved-road' style IDP using Kubernetes-native technologies, supporting continuous deployment and the use of 'review applications' with on-demand infrastructure dependencies
  - Worked with product architects to advocate for forward-looking choices in the decomposition of a monolithic application into microservices
  - Developed self-serve tooling to aid in the rapid spin-up of new services, including self-service infrastructure with automated secrets management, platform onboarding of new services and sensible defaults for CI practices with escape hatches for special cases
  - Participated in migration of Rails monolith from Heroku to GKE
  - Tirelessly promoted a Platform Engineering mindset with an emphasis on the platform as a product ecosystem and on utilizing software engineering as a means of managing operational complexity
- **Tabula Rasa Healthcare** — Charleston, SC
  Platform Engineer — *May 2019 - September 2020*
  - Implemented a set of python microservices to support rapid iteration on new platform capabilities including a paved-road style CI/CD system, automated access provisioning for engineers, business process automation and new service onboarding
  - Deployed and managed both the above-mentioned Internal Developer Platform and customer-facing production systems on Google Kubernetes Engine and CloudFoundry, respectively
  - Wrote and maintained terraform configuration for GCP and AWS
  - Developed an internal customer-facing Service Catalog for automation of infrastructure requests

- Configured a fully-tested, self-bootstrapping Jenkins CasC deployment on GKE along with a highly generic groovy shared library to facilitate 'paved-road' pipelines for apps deployed to CloudFoundry.

- **Articulate** Remote from Charleston, SC
  Software Engineer/Platform Engineer *May 2015 - April 2019*
  - Implemented and maintained a highly customized authentication solution for use across a new SaaS platform, extending Auth0's OAuth2 service to meet business requirements while minimizing costs
  - Designed, implemented and maintained multiple web apps and services in ruby (rails & sinatra) and node.js (hapi)
  - Oversaw the migration and sunsetting of legacy in-house auth system
  - Implemented two terraform providers to enable IaC for two of our vendors - Ohdear and Okta
  - Consulted product developers in managing infrastructure configuration for their services
  - Supported a production environment running in AWS Elastic Beanstalk, with Jenkins CI and a docker-based developer environment

- **Symbolforce** Remote from Charleston, SC
  Web Developer *November 2013 - May 2015*
  - Developed iOS applications for external customers
  - Implemented a web-based collaborative musical performance app in support of a travelling electronic music exhibition
  - Maintained and extended multi-tier microservices-based web APIs implemented in ruby for a prominent video game company
  - Converted a top 100 news and entertainment site to an all-HTML5 video platform
  - Managed client expectations and coordinated with third-party client vendors

- **Jack Russell Software Company** Charleston, SC
  Programmer/Analyst *May 2012 - October 2013*
  - Developed and maintained production web applications using Ruby on Rails and Sinatra
  - Implemented generic, highly extensible configuration management for use across multiple services
  - Represented engineering stakeholders in management of release cycle for all products
  - Encouraged best practices to address productionization during development
  - Deployed releases to QA and Production environments using AWS EC2

Education

- **College of Charleston** Charleston, SC
  Bachelor of Arts in Music *2009*

References available upon request